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October 11, 1967
INTERIM REVISION OF
Fed. Spec. GG-O-588b
April 10, 1964

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

OPENER, LETTER, HAND, METAL

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Standardization Division, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward any recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized Federal agencies to use this Interim document as a valid exception to Federal Specification GG-O-588b dated April 10, 1964.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers metal letter openers for general office use.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Type. Letter openers covered by this specification shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.1):

Type I. - Offset blade type.
Type II. - Straight or flat type.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566--Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636--Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665--Boxes; Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676--Boxes, Set-Up.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Test Methos Std. N. 151 - Metals; Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the index. The index which includes cummulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Auburn, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

FSC 7520

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Military Specification:

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Material shall be steel, heat-treated or worked to a Brinnell hardness of 253 to 421 and treated to resist corrosion as specified in 3.1.2, or shall be corrosion resisting steel. (see 4.5.1).

3.1.1 Thickness. Thickness of metal for type I and type II openers shall be 0.065 ± 0.002-inch.

3.1.2 Finish. Openers shall be nickel or chromium-plated unless made of corrosion resistant steel. All surfaces shall be smoothly polished.

3.2 Length of openers.

3.2.1 Length of type I opener shall be 8-13/16 ± 1/4 inch from tip to end of handle.

3.2.2 Length of type II opener shall be 9 ± 1/4 inch from tip to end of handle.

3.3 Size of blades.

3.3.1 Blade of type I opener shall be 5-1/2 inches ± 1/8-inch long from point of offset. Edges and tip shall have a bevel with a thickness of 0.020-inch ± 0.005-inch. Width of blade shall be 5/16 inch throughout and end of blade shall be tapered to form an oval tip.

3.3.2 Blade of type II opener shall be 6 inches ± 1/8-inch long. Both edges and tip shall have a bevel with a thickness of 0.020-inch ±0.005-inch. Width of blade shall be 5/16-inch ± 1/16-inch throughout and end of blade shall be tapered to form an oval tip.

3.4 Size of handles.

3.4.1 Handle of type I opener shall be 3 inches ± 1/8-inch long from point of offset to end of handle and 3/4-inch ± 1/16-inch wide at the end of the handle, tapering to not less than 5/8-inch width at point of offset, or shall be 3/4-inch ± 1/16-inch wide for the entire length of the handle. The end of the handle shall be rounded. A 3/16-inch hole near the end or a slot 2-1/4 inches maxium longitude by 1/4-inch in width ~~with~~ ends of slot rounded shall be provided in the handle.

3.4.2 Handle of type II opener shall be 3 inches ± 1/8-inch long and 3/4-inch ± 1/16-inch wide at the end of the handle, tapering to not less than 5/8-inch in width at the junction of the blade shall be 3/4-inch ± 1/16-inch wide for the entire length of the handle. The end of the handle shall be rounded. A 3/16-inch hole near the end or a slot 2-1/4-inches maximum longitude by ½-inch in width with ends of slot rounded shall be provided in the handle.

3.5 Construction.

3.5.1 Type I opener shall have blade offset approximately 7/16-inch from handle at a distance approximately 5-1/2 inches from tip of blade.

3.5.2 Type II opener shall lie flat on its surface through entire length.

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3.6 Workmanship. The openers shall be free from burrs and other defects which affect their appearance or which may impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.1), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection lot. All openers offered for delivery at one time shall be considered a lot for purposes of inspection.

4.3 Sampling for lot acceptance.

4.3.1 Sampling for examination of preparation for delivery. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-3. The sample unit shall be one fully packed shipping. container.

4.3.2 Sampling for examination of openers. A random sample of openers shall be selected om each lot offered to the Government in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level I. The sample unit shall be one opener.

4.3.3 Sampling for tests. A random sample of openers shall be selected from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-3. The sample unit shall be one opener.

4.4 Examination.

4.4.1 Examination of preparation for delivery. Samples selected in accordance with 4.3.1 shall be examined to determine compliance with the packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0 percent defective.

4.4.2 Examination of openers. Sample openers, selected in accordance with 4.3.2. shall be examined for defects listed in table I. Any opener in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective units in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 2.5 percent defective for major defects and 4.0 percent for minor defects.

4.4.3 Test. Sample openers, selected in accordance with 4.3.3 shall be subjected to the test described in 4.5. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 2.5 percent defective.

TABLE I.
Classification of defects

Defects	Category	
	Major	Minor
Not type specified.	X	
Dimensions not as specified, within tolerance.	X	
Hole or slot nor provided in handle.	X	
Construction not as specified.	X	
Workmanship: Any defects which--		
Impair serviceability.	X	
Affect appearance.		X

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4.5 Test.

4.5.1 Corrosion test. Sample openers shall be subjected to a 20-percent sodium-chloride solution spray test in accordance with method 811 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 151 for a period of 2 hours. Evidence of corrosion will be considered as failure to meet the requirements of this specification.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. The openers shall be packaged in boxes conforming to PPP-B-566, style II, type A or B, class a; PPP-B-665, style optional; or to PPP-B-676, type optional. Each box shall be waterproofed in accordance with Mil-P-116, method IC-2.

5.1.2 Level B. Twelve openers shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1 except that waterproofing of boxes shall not be required.

5.1.3 Level C. The openers shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's standard practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. The openers shall be packed in boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, V3c. Each box shall be waterproof sealed with tape and reinforced with bands of filament tape in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twelve packages of twelve openers each shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1 except the boxes shall be class 1, domestic and waterproofing shall not be required. Sealing and closures, shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The openers shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking. (see 6.1)

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order, marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123. Each box of 12 openers shall be marked on one end with the Federal Stock Number, Federal Item Identification, and the quantity contained therein.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order, shipments shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired option offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Inspection responsibility if other than specified herein; and administrative provisions for inspection records when applicable (see 4.1).
(d) Levels of packaging and packing and any special marking for shipment required (see 5.1, 5.2, and 5.3.)

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6.2 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

6.3 Federal specifications do not include all types, classes, grades, etc., of the commodities indicated by the titles of the specifications, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover the types, etc., which are suitable for Federal Goverment requirements.

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain copies and other documents referenced herein. Price _____ cents each.

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